(v) *WTO Commitments:* There are certain time- bound obligatory commitments of India towards the provisions of WTO in the area of agriculture which are highly detrimental to the people and the economy. We may see this challenge from two angles—

(a) According to the agricultural provisions, the total subsidies forwarded by the government to the sector must not cross 10 per cent of the total agricultural outputs. At the same time, exemptions to farmers are to be withdrawn—hampering the Public Distribution System badly. India's subsidies are still far below this limit but pose a threat to the sovereign decision of need to be increased.

(b) The subsidies (with different names) to agriculture which are forwarded by the developed countries are highly detrimental to Indian agriculture and they are very high, too[71].

None of the above-given challenges are easy to fight. These are not to be fought by India only but almost all developing countries are to face it. Once the WTO comes into operation, many experts from India and abroad have provided ways to fight these challenges which may be summed up in the following way—

(i) To fight the challenges related to self-sufficiency in food, the price stability and the cropping pattern a judicious mix of suitable kind of agricultural policy and the trade policy will be the need of the hour. To the extent agricultural policy is concerned, India has a limited level of freedom. But the WTO regime does not allow the member countries to impose higher tarrif or tarrif itself to ward off cheaper agri-goods from entering the economy—this is the main reason behind the above challenges. It means it is essential to modify, change or revise the provisions of the WTO.

Similarly, the issue of agricultural subsidies (*the Boxes*) need to be equitably defined so that they do not look biased. Here also the provisions of the WTO need revision.

To fight out this typical challenge experts suggested that the ***WTO is not God-given***. Its provisions may go in for change if concerted efforts are made by the member countries in this direction. Like-minded nations who